

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 9, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 14:1-12

1 Pursue love, and desire spiritual gifts, but especially that you may prophesy.

2 For he who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men but to God, for no one understands him; however, in the spirit he speaks mysteries.

3 But he who prophesies speaks edification and exhortation and comfort to men.

4 He who speaks in a tongue edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the church.

5 I wish you all spoke with tongues, but even more that you prophesied; for he who prophesies is greater than he who speaks with tongues, unless indeed he interprets, that the church may receive edification.

6 But now, brethren, if I come to you speaking with tongues, what shall I profit you unless I speak to you either by revelation, by knowledge, by prophesying, or by teaching?

7 Even things without life, whether flute or harp, when they make a sound, unless they make a distinction in the sounds, how will it be known what is piped or played?

8 For if the trumpet makes an uncertain sound, who will prepare for battle?

9 So likewise you, unless you utter by the tongue words easy to understand, how will it be known what is spoken? For you will be speaking into the air.

10 There are, it may be, so many kinds of languages in the world, and none of them is without significance.

11 Therefore, if I do not know the meaning of the language, I shall be a foreigner to him who speaks, and he who speaks will be a foreigner to me.

12 Even so you, since you are zealous for spiritual gifts, let it be for the edification of the church that you seek to excel.

II. Key Summary

- Paul urges believers to pursue love and especially desire the gift of prophecy above other spiritual gifts
 - Speaking in tongues speaks to God and edifies the speaker; prophecy speaks to people and edifies the whole church
 - Paul uses musical instruments as an analogy to show that sounds without clarity — like unintelligible speech — are useless to those who hear them
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III. Passage Analysis

Gifts Are for Others, Not Just for Yourself

"Spiritual gifts are not personal possessions for individual gratification but communal resources for strengthening the entire church body through self-sacrificial love." [1]

Paul values tongues — he even said he spoke in tongues more than the Corinthians — but in a church gathering, he would rather speak five understandable words than ten thousand in a tongue. A gift that only blesses the one using it falls short of what God intends for community life.

Being Understood Is Where Helpfulness Begins

"What cannot be understood, never can edify." [2]

Paul's trumpet illustration makes the point plainly: if a soldier hears a confused signal, he has no idea what to do. Passion and sincerity aren't enough if the other person can't follow what you're saying. Actually reaching someone — that's where building them up starts.

IV. Reflection Question

Think about something you're genuinely good at — music, talking, art, sports, whatever it is. When you use that skill, is it mostly for your own enjoyment, or do you ever think about how it could help someone else?

Paul says if you're eager for spiritual gifts, go after the ones that build others up — maybe the abilities you have were never meant only for you.

References

- [1] BibleProject, Book of 1 Corinthians Guide,
<https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-1-corinthians/>
- [2] BibleHub, Matthew Henry Commentary,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/14-1.htm